

fashioned pullout locker drawers. You can find them in the organizational aisle at your home improvement store. Following the container principle can help you feel organized instead of cluttered.

5. Wall storage

You can use anything from peg board and hooks to specialized hanging racks from the home and garden store. DIY shelving is another great idea to use up wall space to its maximum. Wall storage is extra efficient because it incorporates the “go vertical” strategy, which leaves you way more room to actually move around.

6. Pare down

It’s amazing how many things we have that we don’t actually need. Sell, give away, or just throw out things that do nothing but take up space.

7. Use even small spaces

There may not seem to be a lot of space between your countertop and the bottom of the cupboards, but there’s room enough for a towel bar and S-hooks to hang necessary kitchen items within easy reach.

8. Like in, like out principle

If a new item comes into the house, like a sweater or souvenir coffee mug, make sure something similar goes out. Take it to the recycling center, Goodwill, a friend, or if necessary to the dump. This will keep you from re-establishing clutter after you have put forth the effort to downsize.

9. Under the bed

This storage real estate is underused much of the time. It’s no place to push aside junk you don’t know what to do with, but it works very well as an efficient and useful storage space.

10. Corner organizational tools

There are many options to maximize corner spaces. Corners are often not used to their maximum efficiency, and any affordable organizing tools can be worth their weight in gold for the small-space dweller.

11. Small-space furniture

There are tons of items out there that are multifunctional when it comes to storage. Ottomans, chairs, coffee tables with lift-off tops and storage compartments, end tables and day beds with rolling storage baskets underneath—these are all items that get you more bang for each square foot.